8.7.1 Formation of Dinucleotide and Polynucleotide

Two nucleotides join to form **dinucleotide** that are linked through 3′-5′ phosphodiester linkage by condensation between phosphate groups of one with sugar of other. This is repeated many times to make **polynucleotide**.

Nucleoside	**Nucleotide**
It is a combination of base and sugar.	It is a combination of nucleoside and phosphoric acid.
Examples	**Examples**
Adenosine = Adenine + Ribose	Adenylic acid = Adenosine + Phosphoric acid
Guanosine = Guanine + Ribose	Guanylic acid = Guanosine + Phosphoric acid
Cytidine = Cytosine + Ribose	Cytidylic acid = Cytidine + Phosphoric acid
Deoxythymidine = Thymine + Deoxyribose	Uridylic acid = Uridine + Phosphoric acid

DO YOU KNOW?

Friedrich Miescher *was the first to isolate a non-protein substance in nuclei of pus cells and named it as* **'Nuclein'**.

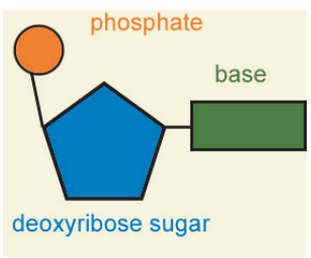


Figure 8.22: Basic component of DNA and RNA

8.7.2 Structure of DNA

Watson and Crick shared the **Nobel Prize** in **1962** for their discovery, along with **Maurice Wilkins**, who had produced the crystallographic data supporting the model. **Rosalind Franklin** (1920–1958) had earlier produced the first clear crystallographic evidence for a helical structure. **James Watson** and **Francis Crick** of Cavendish laboratory in Cambridge built a scale model of double helical structure of DNA which is the most prevalent form of DNA, the **B-DNA**. This is the secondary structure of DNA.

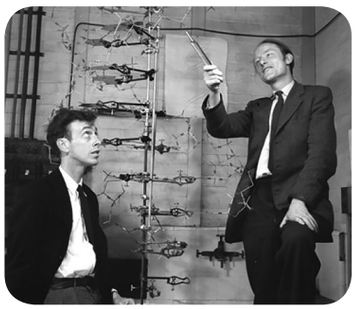


Figure 8.23: Watson and Crick

As proposed by **James Watson and Francis Crick**, DNA consists of right handed double helix with 2 helical polynucleotide chains that are coiled around a common axis to form right handed B form of DNA. The coils are held together by hydrogen bonds which occur between complementary pairs of nitrogenous bases. The sugar is called **2′-deoxyribose** because there is no hydroxyl at position 2′. Adenine and thiamine base pairs has two hydrogen bonds while guanine and cytosine base pairs have three hydrogen bonds.

As published by **Erwin Chargaff** in 1949, a purine pairs with pyrimidine and vice versa**.** Adenine (A) always pairs with Thymine (T) by double bond and Guanine (G) always pairs with Cytosine (C) by triple bond.



Figure 8.24: Rosalind franklin

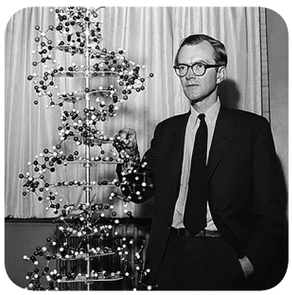


Figure 8.25: Erwin Chargaff

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